

Zahid Ullah

Cybersecurity Analyst | Ethical Hacker | SOC & Threat Intelligence

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Certified and results driven cybersecurity professional with a strong foundation in threat detection, incident response, and network security. Proven ability to translate complex theoretical security concepts into actionable defense strategies through the development of a modular malware detection system. Highly proficient in Python automation, SIEM monitoring, and forensic analysis. Holds a comprehensive suite of industry certifications from (ISC)², Google, IBM, and Fortinet, demonstrating a commitment to protecting critical digital assets and maintaining high-level security posture in remote-first environments.

CORE CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS

1. CyberGun: Dynamic & Static Threat Detection System

- **Architecture:** Developed an end-to-end malware detection framework that unifies static signature analysis with machine learning-driven behavioral threat detection to enhance real-time response accuracy.
- **Engineering:** Architected and implemented modular detection engines (Behavioral, System Activity, USB Monitoring, and Sandbox-based simulation) orchestrated through a custom **DynamicEngine**.
- **Data Science:** Trained and integrated supervised learning models on **EMBER** and **CIC Datasets**, achieving high precision in anomaly classification and predictive malware detection.
- **Interface:** Designed a PyQt5-powered real-time threat intelligence dashboard with a custom **SignalBus architecture** for seamless, asynchronous inter-module communication and logging.

2. Network Intrusion Detection & Monitoring (NIDS) | Suricata, Zeek, Kibana

- **Deployment:** Deployed and configured a NIDS using **Suricata** and **Zeek** within a simulated network environment to monitor for malicious traffic, including port scans, DoS attacks, and data exfiltration.
- **Rule Creation:** Authored and tuned custom detection rules to identify specific attack patterns, significantly reducing false positives and improving alert fidelity.
- **Analysis:** Ingested, parsed, and visualized network telemetry in **Kibana dashboards**, enabling real-time threat hunting and traffic analysis.

3. Incident Response & Digital Forensics (IBM Capstone) | Volatility, Autopsy

- **Investigation:** Conducted a full-cycle investigation of a simulated ransomware breach as part of the IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Capstone, following the **NIST Incident Response Framework**.
- **Forensics:** Performed volatile memory analysis using **Volatility** to identify malicious processes and used **Autopsy** for file system artifact recovery and attack timeline reconstruction.
- **Reporting:** Authored a comprehensive incident report detailing the attack vector, **Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)**, and specific remediation strategies to prevent re-infection.

4. Python Security Automation Toolkit (Google Cybersecurity Project)

- **Automation:** Developed Python-based utilities to automate log analysis, IOC extraction, and suspicious process detection using **Regex** and **OSINT APIs** (VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB).
- **Tooling:** Packaged scripts as CLI tools with command-line argument parsing for efficient use by SOC analysts during triage.

5. Vulnerability Assessment & System Hardening | Nmap, OpenVAS

- **Assessment:** Conducted comprehensive vulnerability scanning on simulated Linux servers, analyzing **CVSS scores** to prioritize critical risks.

- **Hardening:** Documented and implemented mitigation steps, including SSH key policies, firewall rule optimization, and patching schedules following Linux security benchmarks.

6.Object-Oriented Crypto Trading Platform | C++, OOP

- **Software Engineering:** Developed a console-based cryptocurrency trading simulation for the University of London's OOP Specialization, implementing core concepts: **Encapsulation, Inheritance, and Polymorphism**.
- **Logic:** Architected a robust class hierarchy for managing OrderBooks, Wallets, and Exchange logic using file-based I/O and efficient parsing mechanisms.

CERTIFICATIONS

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| • Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) | (ISC) ² |
| • Fortinet Network Security | Fortinet, Inc. |
| • Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) | CISCO / NAVTTC Pakistan |
| • Google Cybersecurity Certificate | Google/Coursera |
| • Google Cloud Cybersecurity Certificate | Google Cloud/ Coursera |
| • IBM Cybersecurity Analyst Certificate | IBM/Coursera |
| • IBM and ISC2 Cybersecurity Specialist | IBM / (ISC) ² / Coursera |
| • OOP Specialization | University of London |

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (2025)

- *University of Peshawar, Pakistan*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Security Tools & Platforms:** Wireshark, Suricata, Zeek, Nmap, OpenVAS, Nessus, Fortinet, Volatility, Autopsy, Splunk, IBM QRadar, Google Chronicle, Kibana, YARA, Wazuh, Snort, Git.
- **Cybersecurity Domains:** Threat Intelligence, Malware Analysis (Static & Dynamic), Incident Response (NIST Framework), Network Security & Firewalls, Digital Forensics, Vulnerability Assessment & System Hardening, Cloud Security (GCP/AWS).
- **Programming & Scripting:** Python (PyQt5, Pandas, Scikit-Learn), Bash, PowerShell, C++ (OOP), SQL, Regex, JSON.

- **Operating Systems:** Windows, Linux (Kali, Ubuntu, Arch, RedHat, Parrot OS).

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Analytical Problem Solving:** Skilled in identifying and mitigating security threats through data-driven analysis.
- **Technical Communication:** Proven ability to document complex security findings into professional-grade reports.
- **Remote Collaboration:** Experienced in working within distributed teams using Git, Slack, and agile methodologies